DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

Jev's verdict: the daf explains itself

Jev score: 0.51 — Ten linked sources tested for non-obvious illumination of the daf (essay, four responsa, two verses, the chapter's own mishna, two Rambam halachot). Top score 0.51; nothing crossed 0.6.

Ten candidates, and not one of them tells you something the daf doesn't already say. The strongest was the chapter's own Mishna, Bekhorot 3:1 (0.51) — the ruling that a goat bought from a gentile in its first year is certainly giving a firstborn — which is simply the case the Gemara's Rav/Shmuel/Rabbi Yochanan debate is built on. The responsa fared worse: the Shoel uMeshiv's mehussar-zeman proof for the Rambam (0.49) rehearses the daf's own question about consecrating an animal before its time; the Noda BiYehudah's part-of-the-day she'eila (0.44) applies the daf's מקצת היום ככולו rather than deepening it.

Honest conclusion: today's daf is self-contained. Its illumination comes from its internal movement — the shepherd reading discharge as evidence, the gezera shava weighing which sanctity governs the tithe — not from the linked library. A day to learn the sugya, not its footnotes.

PARSHA · BERESHIT

Firstlings and fetal life — a faint echo at best

Jev score: 0.46 — Six candidate connections between Bekhorot 21's themes and Parashat Bereshit tested for grounding in the texts. Top score 0.46; none strong.

The two best candidates both landed at 0.46 and both feel like half-connections. The daf's shepherds reading a discharge for signs of a hidden fetus faintly rhymes with Adam being shown the animals to name (Gen 2:19-20) — both are about knowing animals — but one is ritual law and the other is cosmology. And the daf's buried blood-mass, treated as a possible consecrated fetus, faintly rhymes with 'in pain shall you bear children' (Gen 3:16) — but the curse is about human labor, not animal firstborns. Even the tempting one — Abel's צאנו בכורות (Gen 4:4), the Torah's first firstling-offering, against a daf entirely about bekhor behemah — scored only 0.39: the daf never mentions it, and the echo is the reader's, not the text's.

Rejected by Jev: Abel's firstlings vs. firstborn law (0.39), 'be fertile and increase' vs. the daf's reproductive calendar (0.45), blood crying from the ground vs. 'bubbles of blood' as evidence (0.43), Noah's ark generations vs. the tithed kid's offspring (0.15).

NEWS CHECK

This week's news stays outside the sugya

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

Jev score: 0.28 — Eight of the week's biggest stories tested against the daf's themes with a strict bar (a shared single word is not a connection). Top score 0.28.

Nothing this week genuinely resonates with Bekhorot 21. The closest candidate — Kenya's first Ebola death and the daf's discharge-sugya, both about reading bodies for signs of a hidden deadly event — scored only 0.28, and honestly it's the kind of link the strict prompt was built to kill: two kinds of diagnosis, nothing more. The October 7 third-anniversary memorials and the disclosure-dispute sugya (who must tell whom what was known) managed 0.24, but 'accountability' is doing all the work there, not the texts. The honest report: a daf about firstborn animals and a week about war, elections, and epidemics simply don't meet.

MAAGARIM · BEKHOR

בכור: the live sweep was blocked; the arc, from the texts

Maagarim itself stayed behind its Cloudflare wall this morning — the interactive challenge never cleared in the live browser, so no entry row, no koderech, no citation sweep. The fallback: the earliest attestation verified in the already-fetched texts is Genesis 4:4, צאנו והבל הביא גם־הוא מבכרות — Abel's firstlings, the word's first appearance, already an offering. From there the arc runs through the plague of the firstborn (the essay's note: Exodus 13, Numbers 3:13 — God sanctified Israel's firstborn because Egypt's were struck) to today's daf, where בכור is no longer a person or an offering but a legal status read off an animal's body: did she give birth before? The word travels from birth-order, to divine claim, to evidentiary problem — and the daf is the far end of that journey, where 'firstborn' is something you have to prove with shepherds and discharges.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.

Sweep status: partial — live lookup blocked by Cloudflare; attestations from Sefaria texts only.

929 · I KINGS 3 (CH. 290)

Ask for a hearing heart

Chapters 1–2 of Kings were the succession — David's death, Adonijah's bid, Solomon's consolidation ending in Shimei's execution. Chapter 3 opens the reign proper, and it opens in three movements: the alliance (3:1), the theophany (3:5–15), and the demonstration (3:16–28). The whole chapter is about how wisdom arrives and how it proves itself.

The first movement is the most awkward: 'ויתחתן שלמה את פרעה' — Solomon marries Pharaoh's daughter. Rashi, following the midrash, dates it with precision: all the time Shimei his teacher was alive, Solomon did not marry her, 'מכאן אמרו: לעולם ידור אדם במקום רבו'

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

— from here they said: a man should always dwell where his teacher dwells. Ralbag is blunter about the legal residue: the marriage came after her conversion, but 'מדרכי התורה היה בזה הענין יציאה קצת' — there was in this matter a slight departure from the Torah's ways, since Egyptians enter the congregation only in the third generation. Malbim reads it as statecraft: having secured the kingdom within, Solomon secured it against the surrounding kings by alliance with a great power. Three commentators, three registers — aggadah, halakhah, politics — on a single verse.

Then Gibeon. אלקים appears to Solomon in a dream: 'שאל מה אתן לך' — ask what I shall give you. Solomon asks for 'לב שמע לשפט את עמך' — a hearing heart to judge Your people. Rashi hears the weight in עמך הכבד: a people is 'heavy' because they have many affairs and come to judgment, and he adds the terrifying corollary — if a judge takes from one gentile litigant and gives to another wrongly, he is not punished; but for Israel, 'הריני נענש עליו עונש נפשות' — I am punished with the punishment of souls. Metzudat David puts it plainly: it is impossible to judge such a people from the wisdom of one's own heart without help from heaven. The request itself is the first act of wisdom: knowing that judgment needs more than intellect.

The answer is famous — 'לב חכם ונבון,' a wise and discerning heart — but the commentators refuse to let it stay a slogan. Radak cites the sages: חכם is one who retains his learning ('למודו'), נבון is one who understands one thing from another. And 'אשר כמוך לא היה לפניך המקיים את' — Radak records two readings: even Moses did not equal him in חכמת הטבע (though in divine wisdom Moses was greater), or simply: among kings. Malbim builds the gift's architecture verse by verse: the wisdom to hear judgment that he asked for, plus universal wisdom — natural, political, divine — that he did not ask for, and with it wealth and honor as wisdom's necessary accompaniments ('גם עשר גם כבוד'), while long life alone is conditional: 'אם תלך בדרכי.' Wisdom is a package; longevity is a covenant.

The third movement is the proof. Radak on 'אז תבאנה' (3:16) insists on the אז: this case came to Solomon as he returned from Gibeon to Jerusalem — the first display of the gift, the receipt for the dream. Ralbag demythologizes the two women: they were probably innkeepers, like Rahab the זונה, and Solomon's gambit was to frighten them so that the truth would surface from their own mouths — 'אשר תחמול יותר על הבן החי יתבאר בלי ספק שהיא אמו' — the one who has more compassion on the living child is unmistakably the mother.

The judgment's literary pivot is the order of the women's words. Malbim on 3:27: Solomon 'להכריע מתוך סדר דבריהם מי החפץ בילד ומי לא' — decided from the order of their words who wanted the child and who did not. The true mother says 'תנו לה את הילוד החי' — give her the living child — and Rashi adds the midrashic seal: a בת קול emerged and said 'היא אמו.' Radak and Metzudat David agree on the plain-sense reading: 'הואיל ומרחמת עליו' — because she had compassion on him.

Notice the thread the chapter sews: לב — heart — appears in the request (לב שמע), in the grant (לב חכם ונבון), and the whole episode is framed by שמע, hearing. Solomon asks to hear,

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

is given a hearing heart, and the proof is that he hears which voice loves the child. The dream is given in sleep; the wisdom is proven awake. The same Gibeon theophany is told in Chronicles (2 Chr 1), where the emphasis falls on the place — the great high place — rather than the night-dream intimacy Kings preserves.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 9:5-6

The beehive as a tent over the dead

Oholot 9:5

בַּמֶּה דְּבָרִים אֲמוּרִים, בִּזְמַן שֶׁפִּיהָ לַחוּץ. הָיָה פִיהָ לִפְנִים, וְכַזַּיִת מִן הַמֵּת נָתוּן תַּחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ מִבַּחוּץ, כֹּל שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד הַזַּיִת, תַּחְתֶּיהָ וְגַבָּהּ וְתוֹכָהּ טָמֵא. וְכֹל שֶׁאֵינוֹ כְּנֶגֶד הַזַּיִת, תּוֹכָהּ וְהַבַּיִת טָהוֹר. בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ בַבַּיִת, הַכֹּל טָמֵא:

When do these rules apply? When the mouth of the hive is pointing outwards. If the mouth is pointing inwards towards the house: if an olive-sized portion of the corpse is placed below or above that part of the hive which is outside, everything directly below or above that olive-sized portion becomes unclean, and everything not directly below or above it and whatever is within the hive and the house remain clean. If the olive-sized portion is within the hive or in the house, everything becomes unclean.

Rambam: If its mouth faced inward, the hive's airspace merges with the house's airspace, and the impurity spreads to everything they share together — and the same law applies to a perforated hive, as he will stipulate next.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: The modern commentary flags a printed variant reading 'and its inside' as an obvious scribal error (the mishna goes on to rule the inside pure). Its real insight is the contrast with mishna 1: a hive whose mouth faces the house merges with the room's airspace, so impurity from the house penetrates the hive and pours back out, contaminating the surroundings as if the impurity had started inside the hive.

Oholot 9:6

הָיְתָה גְבוֹהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה תַחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ בַבַּיִת אוֹ בְתוֹכָהּ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא:

In the case of the hive being one handbreadth high off the ground: if there is uncleanness below it or in the house or above it, everything becomes unclean.

Rambam: 'Everything is unclean' — everything in the house or the hive, beneath it and above it; but the hive itself does not become impure, as he established earlier.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT YIBBUM VACHALITZAH 5

Four acts, thirty rulings, one combinatorics of release

Halachah 1

הַיְבָמָה שֶׁנִּתַּן לָהּ הַיָּבָם גֵּט כְּרִיתוּת פְּסָלָהּ וּפָסַל אֶת צָרוֹתֶיהָ עָלָיו וְעַל שְׁאָר הָאַחִין שֶׁהֲרֵי נַעֲשָׂה

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

כְּמִי שֶׁחָלַץ לָהּ. וְאֵין הַגֵּט מוֹעִיל בִּיבָמָה אֶלָּא מִדִּבְרֵיהֶן הוֹאִיל וְהַגֵּט מְגָרֵשׁ אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ. וְכָל גֵּט שֶׁפּוֹסֵל אִשְׁתּוֹ מִן הַכְּהֻנָּה פּוֹסֵל אֶת יְבִמְתּוֹ מִן הַיִּבּוּם וְאֵינָהּ מֻתֶּרֶת לְזָר עַד שֶׁיַּחֲלֹץ לָהּ:

When a yavam gives a yevamah a bill of divorce (a get), he disqualifies her and all of [his deceased brother's] other wives [from performing yibbum] with him or with any of the other brothers. It is considered as if he has performed chalitzah with her. The power of a get to affect a yevamah is Rabbinic in origin. [They instituted this decree based on the following rationale:] Since a get has the power to bring about the divorce of a married woman, and every get causes a woman to be disqualified from the priesthood, [they decreed] that it should also disqualify a yevamah from performing yibbum. [The yevamah] is not permitted to marry another man, however, until she performs chalitzah.

Halachah 2

הַמַּאֲמָר אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵינוֹ קוֹנֶה בִּיבָמָה קִנְיַן גָּמוּר וְאֵינָהּ נַעֲשֵׂית בּוֹ אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ גְּמוּרָה צְרִיכָה מִמֶּנּוּ גֵּט וְאֵינָהּ נִתֶּרֶת לְזָר אֶלָּא בַּחֲלִיצָה:

A statement of intent to marry (ma'amar) does not fully effect the establishment of a marriage bond for a yevamah, and it does not cause her to become a married woman in the full sense. Nevertheless, [if the yavam desires to nullify the ma'amar,] he must give [the yevamah] a get. For her to marry another man, however, chalitzah must be performed.

Halachah 3

כֵּיצַד. הָעוֹשֶׂה מַאֲמָר בִּיבִמְתּוֹ וְאֵינוֹ רוֹצֶה לִבְעֹל צָרִיךְ לִכְתֹּב לָהּ גֵּט שֶׁהֲרֵי נִתְקַדְּשָׁה לוֹ. וְצָרִיךְ לַחֲלֹץ לָהּ כְּדֵי לְהַתִּירָהּ לְזָר. שֶׁאֵין הַיְבָמָה נִתֶּרֶת לְזָר אֶלָּא אַחַר בְּעִילַת הַיָּבָם אוֹ אַחַר חֲלִיצָה. אֲבָל הַגֵּט פּוֹסְלָהּ לְיִבּוּם וְאֵינוֹ מַתִּירָהּ לְזָר. וְהַמַּאֲמָר אֵינוֹ קוֹנֶה בָּהּ קִנְיָן גָּמוּר כְּמוֹ הַבְּעִילָה:

What is implied? When [a yavam] gives a ma'amar to his yevamah, but does not desire to engage in sexual relations with her, he must write a get for her, since she was consecrated unto him, and he must perform chalitzah with her to cause her to be permitted to others. For a yevamah is not permitted to marry another man unless she enters into sexual relations with her yavam [and then is divorced or widowed], or if she performs chalitzah. A get disqualifies her for yibbum, but does not permit her to marry another man. A ma'amar does not effect a marriage bond in a complete sense, as sexual relations do.

Halachah 4

נָתַן מַאֲמָר לִיבִמְתּוֹ וְחָזַר וְנָתַן גֵּט לְמַאֲמָרוֹ מַה שֶּׁעָשָׂה הֵרִי בִּטְּלוֹ וְהֻתְּרָה. וְיֵרָאֶה לִי שֶׁלֹּא הֻתְּרָה אֶלָּא לְאֶחָיו אֲבָל זֶה שֶׁנָּתַן הַגֵּט אֲסוּרָה הִיא לוֹ:

When [a yavam] gives a ma'amar to his yevamah and then gives her a get [to nullify his ma'amar], he has negated what he brought about, and [the yevamah] is free [to perform yibbum]. It appears to me that she is free only [to perform yibbum] with his brothers, but

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

she is forbidden to him.

Halachah 5

נָתַן גֵּט לְזִקָּתוֹ [וְלֹא לְמַאֲמָרוֹ] פְּסָלָהּ עָלָיו וְעַל שְׁאָר הָאַחִין כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ וּצְרִיכָה גֵּט לְמַאֲמָרוֹ וַחֲלִיצָה לְהַתִּירָהּ לָזָר:

When [a yavam] gives a get [to his yevamah] [to nullify] his connection to her and not {to nullify his ma'amar}, he disqualifies her [from performing yibbum] with him and his other brothers, as stated above. He must give her [another] get [to negate] his ma'amar and perform chalitzah with her to permit her to marry another man.

Halachah 6

הַמַּאֲמָר שֶׁנִּתַּן לְיִבָמָה תְּחִלָּה וְלֹא קִדְּמוֹ דָּבָר אַחֵר וְלֹא נַעֲשָׂה אַחֲרָיו דָּבָר אַחֵר אֶלָּא שֶׁבָּעַל אוֹתָהּ זֶה שֶׁנִּתַּן לָהּ הַמַּאֲמָר הוּא הַנִּקְרָא מַאֲמָר כָּשֵׁר. וְאִם קִדְּמוֹ גֵּט אוֹ חֲלִיצָה בֵּין מִיָּבָם זֶה בֵּין מִיָּבָם אַחֵר בֵּין בָּהּ בֵּין בְּצָרָתָהּ. וְכֵן אִם קִדְּמַתּוּ בְּעִילָה בְּצָרָתָהּ בֵּין מִמֶּנּוּ בֵּין מֵאֶחָיו. אוֹ שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה אַחֲרָיו גֵּט אוֹ חֲלִיצָה בֵּין בָּהּ בֵּין בְּצָרָתָהּ בֵּין מִמֶּנּוּ בֵּין מֵאֶחָיו. אוֹ שֶׁבָּעַל אוֹ נָתַן מַאֲמָר אַחֵר לְצָרָתָהּ בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו. אוֹ שֶׁנִּתַּן לָהּ אָחִיו מַאֲמָר אַחֵר אוֹ בָּעָלָהּ הֲרֵי זֶה נִקְרָא מַאֲמָר פָּסוּל. בֵּין הַמַּאֲמָר שֶׁקִּדְּמוּהוּ הַמַּעֲשִׂים הָאֵלּוּ בֵּין הַמַּאֲמָר שֶׁנִּתְאַחֲרוּ אַחֲרָיו:

When a ma'amar is given to a yevamah at the outset, without its having been preceded by any other activity and without its having been followed by any activity other than the sexual relations between [the yavam] who gave the ma'amar and the yevamah, the ma'amar is referred to as "an acceptable ma'amar." By contrast, a ma'amar is referred to as "an unacceptable ma'amar" when: a) before the ma'amar either this yavam or one of his brothers gave a get to this yevamah or one of the deceased brother's other wives or performed chalitzah with her, b) either he or one of his brothers engaged in sexual relations with one of the deceased brother's other wives beforehand, c) after the ma'amar, either this yavam or one of his brothers gave a get to this yevamah or one of the deceased brother's other wives or performed chalitzah with her, d) he or one of his brothers engaged in sexual relations with one of the deceased brother's other wives or gave a ma'amar to one of them, or e) one of his brothers gave a ma'amar or engaged in sexual relations [with the yevamah to whom he gave the ma'amar]. [This term applies to] both a ma'amar that preceded these deeds as well as to a ma'amar that was given afterwards.

Halachah 7

כֵּיצַד. נָתַן גֵּט אוֹ חָלַץ לִיבִמְתּוֹ וְחָזַר וְנָתַן מַאֲמָר לָהּ אוֹ לְצָרָתָהּ בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו. אוֹ שֶׁבָּא עַל יְבִמְתּוֹ אוֹ נָתַן לָהּ מַאֲמָר וְחָזַר וְנָתַן לָהּ מַאֲמָר אַחֵר לְצָרָתָהּ בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו. אוֹ שֶׁנָּתַן מַאֲמָר לִיבִמְתּוֹ וְחָזַר אָחִיו וְנָתַן לָהּ מַאֲמָר אַחֵר אוֹ בָּעָלָהּ הֲרֵי זֶה מַאֲמָר פָּסוּל בֵּין הַמַּאֲמָר הָרִאשׁוֹן בֵּין

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

הַמַּאֲמָר הָאַחֲרוֹן:

What is implied? If [a yavam] a) gave a get or performed chalitzah with his yevamah and afterwards he or one of his brothers gave her or another of his deceased brother's wives a ma'amar, or b) he entered into relations with his yevamah or gave her a ma'amar, and then he or one of his brothers gave another of his deceased brother's wives a ma'amar or entered into relations with her, the ma'amar is unacceptable. This applies both to the first ma'amar and the second ma'amar.

Halachah 8

נִמְצֵאתָ לָמֵד שֶׁהַמַּאֲמָר בֵּין שֶׁקִּדְּמוֹ מַאֲמָר אַחֵר אוֹ גֵּט אוֹ חֲלִיצָה אוֹ בְּעִילָה. בֵּין שֶׁקִּדֵּם הַמַּאֲמָר לְאֶחָד מֵאֵלּוּ. הֲרֵי זֶה מַאֲמָר פָּסוּל. חוּץ מִן הַנּוֹתֵן מַאֲמָר וּבָעַל בְּעִילָה אַחַר הַמַּאֲמָר שֶׁזּוֹ הִיא כְּהִלְכָתָהּ:

Thus, we may conclude that whether a ma'amar was preceded by another ma'amar, a get, a chalitzah, or sexual relations, or whether any of these acts preceded a ma'amar, the ma'amar is unacceptable. The only exception is when [a yavam] gives a ma'amar and enters into sexual relations [with the yevamah] after the ma'amar; this follows the dictates of the law.

Halachah 9

הַבְּעִילָה שֶׁבּוֹעֵל הַיָּבָם אֶת יְבִמְתּוֹ תְּחִלָּה אוֹ אַחַר מַאֲמָרוֹ בָּהּ וְלֹא קִדְּמָהּ דָּבָר אַחֵר נִקְרֵאת בְּעִילָה כְּשֵׁרָה. וְאִם קִדְּמָהּ מַאֲמָר מֵאֶחָיו אוֹ גֵּט בֵּין מִמֶּנּוּ בֵּין מֵאֶחָיו בֵּין בָּהּ בֵּין בִּצָּרָתָהּ. אוֹ שֶׁקִּדְּמָהּ מַאֲמָר בִּצָּרָתָהּ בֵּין מִמֶּנּוּ בֵּין מֵאֶחָיו הֲרֵי זוֹ נִקְרֵאת בְּעִילָה פְּסוּלָה:

When a yavam enters into sexual relations with his yevamah at the outset or after giving her a ma'amar, and nothing else preceded [their relations], [their] relations are referred to as "acceptable." If a) a ma'amar from one of his brothers [was given to this yevamah], b) a get was given [to this yevamah] or to one of [the deceased brother's] other wives, or c) a ma'amar [was given by this yavam] or one of his brothers to one of [the deceased brother's] other wives, before [the yavam and the yevamah entered into relations], the relations are referred to as unacceptable.

Halachah 10

הַחֲלִיצָה שֶׁחוֹלֵץ הַיָּבָם לִיבִמְתּוֹ תְּחִלָּה אִם לֹא קִדְּמָהּ דָּבָר אַחֵר נִקְרֵאת חֲלִיצָה מְעֻלָּה. וְאִם קִדְּמָהּ גֵּט אוֹ מַאֲמָר בֵּין מִיָּבָם זֶה בֵּין מֵאֶחָיו בֵּין בָּהּ בֵּין בִּצָּרָתָהּ הֲרֵי זוֹ נִקְרֵאת חֲלִיצָה פְּחוּתָה:

When a yavam performs chalitzah with his yevamah at the outset without any other activity preceding it, the act is referred to as "a superior chalitzah." If [the chalitzah] was preceded by a get or a ma'amar, whether from this yavam or from his brothers, [which was given] either to this yevamah or to one of [the deceased brother's] other wives, the act is

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

referred to as an "inferior chalitzah."

Halachah 11

יְבָמוֹת רַבּוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּבְעֲלָה אַחַת מֵהֶן בְּעִילָה כְּשֵׁרָה אוֹ נֶחְלְצָה חֲלִיצָה מְעֻלָּה הֻתְּרוּ הַכֹּל וְנִסְתַּלְּקָה זִקַּת הַיָּבָם מֵעֲלֵיהֶן. וְאִם נִבְעֲלָה אַחַת מֵהֶן בְּעִילָה פְּסוּלָה אוֹ נִתַּן לָהּ מַאֲמָר פְּסוּל נֶאֶסְרוּ כֻּלָּן לְיִבּוּם וּצְרִיכָה גֵּט זוֹ שֶׁנִּבְעֲלָה אוֹ שֶׁנִּתַּן לָהּ מַאֲמָר. וּצְרִיכָה חֲלִיצָה [כָּל] אַחַת מֵהֶן לְהַתִּירָן לְזָר. שֶׁאֵין זִקַּת הַיִּבּוּם מִסְתַּלֶּקֶת בִּבְעִילָה פְּחוּתָה:

When there are many yevamot coming from one household, after one of them has entered into "acceptable relations" or performed a "superior chalitzah," all are permitted [to marry other men], and their obligation to the yavam is removed. If one of them entered into "unacceptable relations" or was given an "unacceptable ma'amar," all the wives are forbidden to perform yibbum. The woman who entered into relations or who received the ma'amar must be divorced with a get. [In addition,] {each} one of them is required to perform chalitzah to be permitted to marry another man. For "unacceptable relations" do not remove [a yevamah's] obligation to her yavam.

Halachah 12

נֶחְלְצָה אַחַת מֵהֶן חֲלִיצָה פְּחוּתָה הֻתְּרָה לְהִנָּשֵׂא לְזָר זוֹ שֶׁנֶּחְלְצָה אֲבָל צָרָתָהּ אֲסוּרָה עַד שֶׁתַּחֲלֹץ גַּם הִיא אוֹ עַד שֶׁיַּחְלְצוּ כָּל הָאַחִין לָרִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁנֶּחְלְצָה הַחֲלִיצָה הַפְּחוּתָה. שֶׁאֵין חֲלִיצָה פְּחוּתָה מְסַלֶּקֶת זִקַּת יִבּוּם מִבַּיִת זֶה עַד שֶׁתַּחֲזֹר עַל כָּל הָאַחִין אוֹ עַד שֶׁתֵּחָלֵץ כָּל אַחַת מֵהֶן:

If one of [a deceased man's wives] performs an "inferior chalitzah," she is permitted to marry another man, but [the deceased's] other wives remain forbidden [to marry] unless they perform chalitzah or unless all the brothers perform chalitzah with [the yevamah] who performed the "inferior chalitzah." For an "inferior chalitzah" does not remove the obligation of yibbum from this household until [the yevamah who performed the "inferior chalitzah" performs chalitzah] with all the brothers, or all [the deceased's wives] perform chalitzah.

Halachah 13

כָּל יְבָמָה שֶׁנִּבְעֲלָה לִיבָמָהּ בֵּין בְּעִילָה כְּשֵׁרָה בֵּין בְּעִילָה פְּסוּלָה. וַאֲפִלּוּ בְּעָלָהּ אַחַר שֶׁחָלַץ לָהּ בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו בֵּין לְשֵׁם אֵישׁוּת בֵּין לְשֵׁם יַבְּמוּת. וַאֲפִלּוּ בְּעַל צָרָתָהּ אַחַר שֶׁבָּעַל בְּעִילָה כְּשֵׁרָה בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו. הֲרֵי זוֹ צְרִיכָה גֵּט שֶׁהֲרֵי נַעֲשֵׂית אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ בַּבְּעִילָה. וְכֵן כָּל יְבָמָה שֶׁנִּתַּן לָהּ מַאֲמָר בֵּין מַאֲמָר כָּשֵׁר בֵּין מַאֲמָר פָּסוּל הֲרֵי זוֹ צְרִיכָה גֵּט מִפְּנֵי הַמַּאֲמָר כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ וְאַחַר כָּךְ יָסוּר אִסּוּר הַמַּאֲמָר:

Whenever a yevamah engages in sexual relations with her yavam, [a get is required to terminate the relationship], regardless of whether or not the relations are acceptable. [This

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

applies] even if [the yavam] engaged in relations with [the yevamah] after performing chalitzah with her. [Similarly, this ruling applies] regardless of whether [a yavam] or his brothers engaged in the relations for the sake of establishing a marriage bond or for the sake of yibbum. Even if [a yavam] or his brother engages in relations with another [one of the deceased's] wives after [the yavam] engages in "acceptable relations" with [his yevamah], he must divorce the woman with a get, for these relations effect the establishment of a marriage bond. Similarly, whenever a yevamah is given a ma'amar - whether an "acceptable ma'amar" or an "unacceptable ma'amar" - a get is required because of the ma'amar, as explained. Only then is the prohibition brought about by the ma'amar removed.

Halachah 14

כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁאֵין הַגֵּט הוֹפֵה הַיְבָמָה דְּחִיָּה גְּמוּרָה וְכֵן הַמַּאֲמָר אֵינוֹ קוֹנֶה בָּהּ קִנְיָן גָּמוּר. אֲבָל הַבְּעִילָה קוֹנָה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר. וְהַחֲלִיצָה הוֹפֵה אוֹתָהּ דְּחִיָּה גְּמוּרָה. לְפִיכָךְ גֵּט אַחַר גֵּט בִּיבָמָה אוֹ מַאֲמָר אַחַר מַאֲמָר מוֹעִיל. אֲבָל בְּעִילָה אַחַר בְּעִילָה וַחֲלִיצָה אַחַר חֲלִיצָה אֵין הָאַחֲרוֹנָה מוֹעֶלֶת כְּלוּם. וְכֵן גֵּט אוֹ חֲלִיצָה אַחַר הַבְּעִילָה אֵינָהּ כְּלוּם:

As mentioned, a get does not dissolve [a yavam's connection with] his yevamah entirely. Similarly, a ma'amar does not acquire her [as a wife for the yavam] in a complete way. It is [only] sexual relations that establish the marriage bond in a complete manner, and it is [only] chalitzah that dissolves the connection entirely. Therefore, when a yevamah is given one get after another, or one ma'amar after another, there is an effect. When, however, [another brother] engages in relations with [a yevamah with whom a yavam] engaged in relations, or performs chalitzah with [a yevamah with whom a yavam] performed chalitzah, the second relations or the second chalitzah are of no consequence. Similarly, a get or chalitzah that follows relations is of no consequence.

Halachah 15

כֵּיצַד. יָבָם שָׁנָתַן גֵּט לִיבְמָתוֹ וְחָזַר וְנָתַן גֵּט לְצָרָתָהּ הֲרֵי זֶה אָסוּר בִּקְרוֹבוֹת שְׁתֵּיהֶן. וְכֵן שְׁנֵי יְבָמִין שֶׁנָּתְנוּ שְׁנֵי גִּטִּין לִיבָמָה אַחַת זֶה אַחַר זֶה הֲרֵי זוֹ כִּגְרוּשָׁה לִשְׁנֵיהֶן וּשְׁנֵיהֶן אֲסוּרִין בִּקְרוֹבוֹתֶיהָ וְאֶחָד מֵהֶן חוֹלֵץ. וְכֵן אִם נָתַן גֵּט לִיבְמָתוֹ וְחָזַר וְנָתַן אָחִיו גֵּט לְצָרָתָהּ כָּל אֶחָד אָסוּר בִּקְרוֹבוֹת זוֹ שֶׁנָּתַן לָהּ הַגֵּט. וְכֵן אִם נָתְנוּ מַאֲמָר אַחַר מַאֲמָר כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ. אֲבָל הַיָּבָם שֶׁחָלַץ לִיבְמָתוֹ וְחָזַר וְחָלַץ לְצָרָתָהּ בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו. וְכֵן שְׁתֵּי יְבָמִין שֶׁחָלְצוּ זֶה אַחַר זֶה לִיבָמָה אַחַת אֵין חֲלִיצָה אַחֲרוֹנָה כְּלוּם וְאֵין הַחוֹלֵץ אוֹתָהּ בָּאַחֲרוֹנָה אָסוּר בִּקְרוֹבוֹתֶיהָ. שֶׁזֶּה כְּחוֹלֵץ לִשְׁאָר הַנָּשִׁים שֶׁאֵין לוֹ עֲלֵיהֶן זִקָּה:

What is implied? When a yavam gives a get to a yevamah, and afterwards gives a get to another one of [the deceased's] wives, he is forbidden to marry the relatives of both women. Similarly, when two yevamim give two gittin to one yevamah, one after the other, she is considered to have been divorced by both of them. They are both forbidden to marry her

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

relatives; one of them should perform chalitzah [with her]. Similarly, if [a yavam] gives a get to his yevamah, and then his brother gives a get to another one of [the deceased's] wives, each brother is forbidden to marry the relatives of the woman to whom he gave the get. Similarly, if [two brothers each] give a ma'amar, one after the other, [each must give a get], as explained. When, however, a yavam performs chalitzah with his yevamah, and afterwards either he or his brother perform chalitzah with another of [the deceased's] wives, or two yevamim perform chalitzah with the same yevamah, the second chalitzah is of no consequence, and the brother who performed it is not forbidden to marry the woman's relatives. It is just as if he performed chalitzah with another woman who is not under obligation to him.

Halachah 16

וְכֵן הַבּוֹעֵל יְבִמְתּוֹ וְחָזַר בֵּין הוּא בֵּין אָחִיו וְחָלַץ לָהּ אוֹ לְצָרָתָהּ אֵין חֲלִיצָה זוֹ כְּלוּם. וְכֵן אִם חָזַר אָחִיו וְנָתַן גֵּט לָהּ אוֹ לְצָרָתָהּ אֵינוֹ כְּלוּם. חָזַר אָחִיו וְנָתַן לָהּ מַאֲמָר אוֹ בָּעַל לֹא עָשָׂה כְּלוּם מֵאַחַר שֶׁבָּעַל אָחִיו תְּחִלָּה קָנָה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר וְאֵין הַקִּדּוּשִׁין תּוֹפְסִין בְּאֵשֶׁת אִישׁ. אֲבָל אִם נָתַן מַאֲמָר לְצָרָתָהּ אוֹ בָּעַל צָרָתָהּ צְרִיכָה גֵּט מִמֶּנּוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

Similarly, when a man engages in relations with his yevamah, and then he or one of his brothers performs chalitzah with her or with one of the other wives [of his deceased brother], this chalitzah is of no consequence. Similarly, if his brother gave a get to [this yevamah or] any of the other wives [of his deceased brother], it is of no consequence. Nor is it of consequence if one of his brothers gives the woman a ma'amar or engages in relations with her. Once the brother engaged in relations with her, he acquired her [as his wife] in a complete manner, and a married woman cannot be consecrated by another man. If, however, one of the brothers gave a ma'amar to one of the other wives [of his deceased brother], or engaged in relations with her, he must release her with a get, as we have explained.

Halachah 17

שְׁנֵי יְבָמִין שֶׁיִּבְּמוּ שְׁתֵּי יְבָמוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד וְלֹא נוֹדַע מִי יִבֵּם תְּחִלָּה שְׁנֵיהֶן יוֹצִיאוּ בְּגֵט וְיֵתְּרוּ לָזָרִים וַאֲסוּרוֹת לַיְבָמִין. לְפִיכָךְ רְאוּבֵן שֶׁהָיָה בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם וְלוֹ שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים אַחַת בְּעַכּוֹ וְאַחַת בְּצוֹר וְשִׁמְעוֹן אָחִיו בְּעַכּוֹ וְלֵוִי אָחִיו בְּצוֹר וְשָׁמְעוּ שֶׁמֵּת רְאוּבֵן הַדִּין נוֹתֵן שֶׁלֹּא יְיַבֵּם אֶחָד מֵהֶן עַד שֶׁיִּוָּדַע מָה עָשָׂה אָחִיו שֶׁמָּא קִדַּם אֶחָד מֵהֶן וְיִבֵּם. קִדַּם אֶחָד מֵהֶן וְיִבֵּם אֵין מוֹצִיאִין מְיָדוֹ עַד שֶׁיִּוָּדַע שֶׁאָחִיו יִבֵּם תְּחִלָּה. רָצָה הָאֶחָד לַחֲלֹץ קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּוָּדַע מָה עָשָׂה אָחִיו אֵין מוֹנְעִין אוֹתוֹ:

[The following rules apply when] two yevamim perform yibbum with two yevamot coming from the same household, and it is not known who performed yibbum first. Both should divorce [the women] with gittin. The women are then permitted to marry other men, but are forbidden to the yevamim. Consequently, when Reuven lived in Jerusalem and he had

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

two wives, one living in Akko and one living in Tyre, [and two brothers:] Shimon who lived in Akko and Levi who lived in Tyre, if there is a report that Reuven died, according to law it would be proper for neither brother to perform yibbum until he knows what his other brother did. For perhaps he performed yibbum first. If one of the brothers does perform yibbum, he is not forced to divorce his wife until it is determined that his other brother performed yibbum first. If one brother desired to perform chalitzah without waiting to see what his other brother did, he is not prevented from doing so.

Halachah 18

יָבָם קָטָן בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד בִּיאָתוֹ כְּמַאֲמָר מִן הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁאֵינוֹ קוֹנֶה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר. וּמַאֲמָר בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד אִם נְתָנוֹ בַּתְּחִלָּה מוֹעִיל וַהֲרֵי הוּא פּוֹסֵל בּוֹ עַל הַגָּדוֹל אֲבָל אִם נְתָנוֹ בַּסּוֹף אֵינוֹ כְּלוּם. וְגִטּוֹ וַחֲלִיצָתוֹ אֵינָם כְּלוּם בֵּין בַּתְּחִלָּה בֵּין בַּסּוֹף׃

When a yavam who is below the age of majority, [but more than] nine years and one day old, enters into relations [with a yevamah], [the consequence] is equivalent to [that of] a ma'amar given by an adult; [the yevamah] is not acquired as a wife in a complete manner. When [a yavam who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old, gives a ma'amar at the outset, it is effective and causes [the yevamah] to be forbidden to [his brothers] who are past majority. If, however, he gives [the ma'amar after a ma'amar has been given by his brothers who are past majority, his ma'amar] is of no consequence. [Similarly,] a get that he gives or chalitzah that he performs is always of no consequence, whether it precedes [his brothers' actions] or follows them.

Halachah 19

כֵּיצַד. בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁבָּא עַל יְבִמְתּוֹ אוֹ שֶׁנָּתַן לָהּ מַאֲמָר תְּחִלָּה פְּסָלָהּ עַל שְׁאָר אַחִין. אֲבָל אִם עָשָׂה הַגָּדוֹל מַאֲמָר בִּיבִמְתּוֹ וְחָזַר בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד וְנָתַן לָהּ אוֹ לְצָרָתָהּ מַאֲמָר לֹא עָשָׂה כְּלוּם וְלֹא פְּסָלָהּ עַל אָחִיו הַגָּדוֹל. חָזַר בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד וּבָא עָלֶיהָ אוֹ עַל צָרָתָהּ אַחַר מַאֲמַר אָחִיו הַגָּדוֹל פְּסָלָהּ עַל הַגָּדוֹל כִּשְׁנֵי גְדוֹלִים שֶׁעָשׂוּ מַאֲמָר אַחַר מַאֲמָר כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ׃

What is implied? When a [yavam who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old, engages in relations with his yevamah, or gives her a ma'amar at the outset, he disqualifies her [from performing yibbum] with his other brothers. If, however, [one of the brothers] past majority gave his yevamah a ma'amar, and then [the brother who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old, gives her or another one of the wives [of the deceased brother] a ma'amar, his actions are of no consequence, and he does not cause [the yevamah] to be forbidden to his elder brother. If, however, [the brother who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old engages in relations with her or with another one of the wives of [the deceased brother], he causes [the yevamah] to be forbidden to his elder brother, as would be the case

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

when two [brothers] past majority each gave a ma'amar one after the other, as we have explained.

Halachah 20

בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁבָּא עַל יְבִמְתּוֹ וְחָזַר אָחִיו הַגָּדוֹל וּבָא עָלֶיהָ אוֹ חָלַץ אוֹ נָתַן גֵּט לָהּ אוֹ לְצָרָתָהּ הֲרֵי זֶה פְּסָלָהּ עַל הַקָּטָן. וְכֵן אִם חָזַר הַקָּטָן וּבָא עַל צָרָתָהּ אוֹ בָּא אָחִיו הָאַחֵר שֶׁהוּא בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד עָלֶיהָ אוֹ עַל צָרָתָהּ נִפְסְלָה עָלָיו כְּדִין כָּל מַאֲמָר וּמַאֲמָר׃

When a [yavam who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old, has engaged in relations with his yevamah, and then one of his brothers past majority entered into relations with her, performed chalitzah with her, gave her a get, or performed one of these activities with another [one of the deceased brother's] wives, he disqualified the minor [from marrying his yevamah]. Similarly, if the minor has engaged in relations with another [one of the deceased brother's] wives, or another brother who is also [below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old, has engaged in relations with this woman, or with another [one of the deceased brother's] wives, [the woman with whom the first brother originally engaged in relations] is disqualified [from marrying him], as is the ruling whenever two ma'amarim are given one after the other.

Halachah 21

בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁבָּא עַל יְבִמְתּוֹ וְהִגְדִּיל וְלֹא בָּא עָלֶיהָ מִשֶּׁהִגְדִּיל צְרִיכָה גֵּט וַחֲלִיצָה. גֵּט מִפְּנֵי בִּיאָתוֹ שֶׁהִיא כְּמַאֲמָר וַחֲלִיצָה לְהַתִּירָהּ לְזָר שֶׁהֲרֵי לֹא נִבְעֲלָה בְּעִילָה שֶׁקּוֹנָה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר. וְאִם בָּא עָלֶיהָ מִשֶּׁהִגְדִּיל הֲרֵי זוֹ צְרִיכָה גֵּט בִּלְבַד׃

When a [yavam who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old, engages in relations with his yevamah and then does not engage in relations with her again after he attains majority, [he is] required [to give her] a get and perform chalitzah. The get [is necessary] because the relations in which he engaged are considered equivalent to a ma'amar. The chalitzah [is necessary] in order to permit the woman to marry another man, for she did not engage in relations that established a complete marriage bond. If [her yavam] engaged in relations with her after he attained majority, all that is required [to enable her to marry another man] is a get.

Halachah 22

אֶחָד בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד. וְאֶחָד בֶּן עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה שֶׁלֹּא הֵבִיא שְׁתֵּי שְׂעָרוֹת וְלֹא נוֹלְדוּ בּוֹ סִימָנֵי סָרִיס כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ בִּתְחִלַּת הַסֵּפֶר׃

[The same laws that apply to a yavam who is below the age of majority, but more than] nine years and one day old [apply to a yavam who] is twenty years old and has not manifested signs of physical maturity, but has also not manifested physical signs of impotency, as

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

explained in the beginning of this book.

Halachah 23

קְטַנָּה שֶׁרְאוּיָה לְמָאֵן. וְהַחֵרֶשֶׁת. אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁקִּדּוּשֵׁי שְׁתֵּיהֶן מִדִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ שְׁנֵי מִינֵי קִדּוּשִׁין הֵן. קְטַנָּה יֵשׁ לָהּ קִדּוּשִׁין כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יִנָּהֲגוּ בָהּ מִנְהַג הֶפְקֵר. וְקִדּוּשֶׁיהָ תְּלוּיִין עַד שֶׁתַּגְדִּיל. וְחֵרֶשֶׁת תִּקְּנוּ לָהּ נְשׂוּאִין כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא תִּשָּׁאֵר פְּנוּיָה לְעוֹלָם. לְפִיכָךְ אִם הָיוּ כָּל הַיְבָמוֹת הַבָּאוֹת מִבַּיִת אֶחָד קְטַנּוֹת אוֹ חֵרְשׁוֹת בִּיאָתָהּ שֶׁל אַחַת מֵהֶן פּוֹטֶרֶת אֶת כֻּלָּן:

As explained, both the consecration of a girl below the age of majority who is fit to leave her husband through the rite of mi'un, and [the consecration of a girl who is] a deaf-mute are Rabbinic institutions. Nevertheless, they are two different types of ordinances. [For] the consecration of a minor was ordained so that [men] will not relate to her in an unrestrained manner. Her consecration is thus tentative until she comes of age. Consecration was ordained for a deaf-mute [for a different reason,] so that she will not remain unmarried forever. Accordingly, if all the yevamot coming from one household are below majority or all are deaf mutes, entering into relations with one of them frees them all from their obligation.

Halachah 24

הָיְתָה אַחַת חֵרֶשֶׁת וְאַחַת קְטַנָּה אֵין בִּיאַת אַחַת מֵהֶן פּוֹטֶרֶת אֶת צָרָתָהּ. וְכֵיצַד תַּקָּנָתָן. מְלַמְּדִין הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁתְּמָאֵן וְכוֹנֵס אֶת הַחֵרֶשֶׁת. וְאִם רָצָה לְגָרְשָׁהּ כּוֹתֵב לָהּ גֵּט אַחַר שֶׁיָּבוֹא עָלֶיהָ וְתֵּתֵּר לְזָר:

If [by contrast, the deceased was married to] a deaf-mute and a minor, engaging in relations with one does not free the other of her obligation. What is the alternative? The minor should be instructed to [nullify her marriage through] mi'un, and [a yavam] should marry the deaf-mute. If he desires to divorce her, he may write a get for her after they engage in relations. She is then permitted [to marry] another man.

Halachah 25

הָיְתָה אַחַת פִּקַּחַת וְאַחַת חֵרֶשֶׁת בִּיאַת הַפִּקַּחַת אוֹ חֲלִיצָתָהּ פּוֹטֶרֶת הַחֵרֶשֶׁת. וְאֵין בִּיאַת הַחֵרֶשֶׁת פּוֹטֶרֶת הַפִּקַּחַת שֶׁאֵין קִדּוּשֶׁיהָ אֶלָּא מִדִּבְרֵיהֶן. וְכֵן גְּדוֹלָה וּקְטַנָּה בִּיאַת הַגְּדוֹלָה אוֹ חֲלִיצָתָהּ פּוֹטֶרֶת הַקְּטַנָּה וְאֵין בִּיאַת הַקְּטַנָּה פּוֹטֶרֶת אֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה:

If one [of the deceased's wives] was mentally competent, and one was a deaf-mute, engaging in relations with the mentally competent woman, or performing chalitzah with her frees the deaf-mute of her obligation. Engaging in relations with the deaf-mute, by contrast, does not free the mentally competent woman [from her obligation]. For the consecration of the deaf-mute is merely a Rabbinic institution. Similar [laws apply when one of the deceased wives was] above majority, and one was a minor. Engaging in relations with the woman past majority, or performing chalitzah with her frees the minor of her

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

obligation. Engaging in relations with the minor, by contrast, does not free the woman past majority [from her obligation].

Halachah 26

הָיוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן קְטַנוֹת הָרְאוּיוֹת לְמָאֵן וּבָא הַיָּבָם עַל אַחַת מֵהֶן וְחָזַר וּבָא אוֹ הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו עַל הַשְּׁנִיָּה לֹא פָּסַל אֶת הָרִאשׁוֹנָה. אֲבָל מְלַמְּדִין אֶת הַשְּׁנִיָּה שֶׁתְּמָאֵן וְיִקַּיֵּם זֶה יְבִמְתּוֹ הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁנִּבְעֶלָה תְּחִלָּה:

[The following rules apply if] both [the deceased's wives] were minors who are entitled to absolve their marriages through mi'un. If the yavam engages in relations with one of them, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the other, this does not disqualify the marriage to the first. Nevertheless, we should instruct [the second one] to dissolve her marriage through] mi'un. He should then maintain [his marriage] with the minor yevamah with whom he engaged in relations first.

Halachah 27

וְכֵן הַדִּין בִּקְטַנָּה וְחֵרֶשֶׁת שֶׁבָּא הַיָּבָם תְּחִלָּה עַל הַקְּטַנָּה וְחָזַר וּבָא הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו עַל הַחֵרֶשֶׁת לֹא פָּסַל אֶת הַקְּטַנָּה וְהַחֵרֶשֶׁת צְרִיכָה גֵּט. שֶׁבִּיאַת הַקְּטַנָּה מְעֻלָּה מִבִּיאַת הַחֵרֶשֶׁת. שֶׁהַקְּטַנָּה רְאוּיָה לְאַחַר זְמַן. לְפִיכָךְ יְקַיֵּם הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁנִּבְעֶלָה תְּחִלָּה:

Similar laws apply if [the deceased was married to] a minor and a deaf-mute. If the yavam first enters into relations with the minor, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the deaf-mute, this does not disqualify the marriage to the minor. The deaf-mute, however, must be divorced via a get. [The rationale is that] the relations with the minor are considered superior to relations with the deaf-mute, for ultimately the minor will be fit [to enter into a marriage bond that is binding according to Scriptural law]. Therefore, he should maintain his relationship with the minor with whom he engaged in relations first.

Halachah 28

בָּא הַיָּבָם תְּחִלָּה עַל הַחֵרֶשֶׁת וְחָזַר וּבָא הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו עַל הַקְּטַנָּה פָּסַל אֶת הַחֵרֶשֶׁת. וּמְלַמְּדִין הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁתְּמָאֵן וְהַחֵרֶשֶׁת יוֹצְאָה בְּגֵט:

[In the above situation,] if the yavam first enters into relations with the deaf-mute, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the minor, this disqualifies the marriage to the deaf-mute. We should instruct the minor to dissolve her marriage through] mi'un; the deaf-mute must be divorced with a get.

Halachah 29

הָיוּ אַחַת פִּקֵּחַת וְאַחַת חֵרֶשֶׁת. בָּא הַיָּבָם עַל הַפִּקֵּחַת וְחָזַר וּבָא הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו עַל הַחֵרֶשֶׁת לֹא פָּסַל אֶת הַפִּקֵּחַת וְהַחֵרֶשֶׁת צְרִיכָה גֵּט. בָּא הַיָּבָם עַל הַחֵרֶשֶׁת וְחָזַר הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו וּבָא עַל הַפִּקֵּחַת פָּסַל

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

אֶת הַחֵרֶשֶׁת. וְהַחֵרֶשֶׁת יוֹצְאָה בְּגֵט. וְהַפִּקֵּחַת בְּגֵט וּבַחֲלִיצָה:

[The following rules apply if the deceased was married to] a mentally competent woman and a deaf-mute. If the yavam engaged in relations with the mentally competent woman, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the deaf-mute, this does not disqualify the marriage to the mentally competent woman. The deaf-mute, however, must be divorced via a get. If the yavam first enters into relations with the deaf-mute, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the mentally competent woman, this disqualifies the marriage to the deaf-mute. The deaf-mute must be divorced with a get, and the mentally competent woman should receive both a get and chalitzah.

Halachah 30

הָיוּ גְּדוֹלָה וּקְטַנָּה וּבָא עַל הַגְּדוֹלָה וְחָזַר הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו וּבָא עַל הַקְּטַנָּה לֹא פָסַל הַגְּדוֹלָה וּמְלַמְּדִין אֶת הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁתְּמָאֵן. בָּא עַל הַקְּטַנָּה וְחָזַר וּבָא הוּא אוֹ אָחִיו עַל הַגְּדוֹלָה. מְלַמְּדִין אֶת הַקְּטַנָּה שֶׁתְּמָאֵן וְיִקַּיֵּם הַגְּדוֹלָה שֶׁבְּעִילָתָהּ קוֹנָה קִנְיָן גָּמוּר:

[The following rules apply if the deceased was married to] a woman past the age of majority and one below the age of majority. [If the yavam] first enters into relations with the woman past majority, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the minor, this does not disqualify the marriage to the woman past majority. We should, however, instruct the minor to dissolve her marriage through mi'un. If he first enters into relations with the minor, and then he or one of his brothers engages in relations with the woman past majority, we should instruct the minor to dissolve her marriage through mi'un, and he should remain married to the woman past majority. [The rationale is that] relations with her establish a fully binding marriage bond.

Commentary

The chapter's architecture is a combinatorics. Four acts — get, ma'amar, chalitzah, relations — can each open the sequence, follow one another, or be performed by a brother instead of the yavam, and the Rambam works the permutations in three movements: first the act-level rules (1-10: a get disqualifies but never dissolves; a ma'amar needs a get plus chalitzah to undo; 'acceptable' vs 'inferior' chalitzah and relations), then the household-level fallout (11-17: what one superior act does for all the co-wives), then the person-level edge cases (18-30: the nine-year-old, the twenty-year-old with no signs of maturity, the deaf-mute, the minor). From acts, to houses, to persons.

The Maggid Mishneh plays his usual role — the source-tracer. On 5:1, where the Rambam rules that a rabbinic get given to a yevamah disqualifies her like chalitzah, the Maggid Mishneh sends you to Yevamot 50a (פרק רבן גמליאל) and quotes the Gemara's rationale: since a get works 'בעלמא' — for an ordinary wife — the rabbis gave it force for the yevamah too,

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

lest people reason 'a get releases, chalitzah releases' and come to permit relations after chalitzah. The ruling is anchored; its logic is pedagogical.

The Ohr Sameach, on the same halachah, does the opposite move — the conceptual analyst's. He asks what the rabbinic get is modeled on: if it was made 'like the get of a wife,' then it works through an agent, as the Rambam rules; if it was made 'like chalitzah,' no agency is possible. The same structural question drives his reading of ma'amar: Rabbi holds it is like bi'ah and works against her will; the Sages hold it is like kiddushin and needs her consent. The Migdal Oz, by contrast, gives the minimalist pole — a one-line pointer to Yevamot 50a and nothing more.

Two gems. First, the Rambam's rare first person in 5:4 — נראה לי, 'it appears to me' — that when a ma'amar followed by a get frees the yevamah, she is free only for the brothers, not for the yavam himself: the decisor stepping out from behind the code in a thicket of conditionals. Second, the chapter's quiet asymmetry principle: inferior acts (get, ma'amar) can only disqualify, never complete; only relations complete, only chalitzah releases cleanly. Disqualification is easy; release is hard.

Read against today's daf — which also weighs competing sanctities (firstborn vs. tithe) by their shared attributes — this chapter is the same legal mind at work: sorting hybrid acts by what they resemble, and letting the resemblance decide the law.

Commentaries: Maggid Mishneh and Ohr Sameach on 5:1 (Sefaria); Migdal Oz's one-line source note.

NLI ·

From the National Library: a study day for today's daf

The National Library's archive holds a flyer — ephemera, one page — advertising a full study day on הלכות בכורות וערלה, held on Sunday, 27 Nisan 5743 (1983) in Jerusalem by the Beit Midrash Gavoha LeHalacha of the agricultural settlements. Its shiurim read like a table of contents for today's daf: 'בכור בהמה טהורה בזמן הזה,' 'חלק הגוי בשותפות' (the gentile-partnership question the sugya debates in the case of buying from a gentile), 'דרכי הקנין במכירת מבכירות.' Forty-three years later, Bekhorot 21 is still live halacha being taught in a Jerusalem hall.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21



בית מדרש גבוה להלכה בהתיישבות החקלאית
ירושלים - שעלבים ◆ ת. ד. 7900 ירושלים

הננו מתכבדים להזמין את הציבור להשתתף

ביום לימוד בהלכות

בכורות וערלה

שיתקיים אי"ה ביום א' כ"ז ניסן תשמ"ג בישיבת דבר
ירושלים רחוב חגי 24 גאולה, עיה"ק ירושלים תובב"א.

◆ סדר השיעורים ◆

אחה"צ 3.45 תפילת מנחה.

4.00 הרה"ג ר' קלמן כהנא שליט"א
ראש ביה"מ"ד
בכור בהמה טהורה בזמן הזה.

4.45 הרב יהושע איתמר שליט"א
כולל נחלת יחיאל
חלק הגוי בשותפות.

5.30 הרב ישראל קופלוביץ שליט"א
חבר ביה"מ"ד
עשיית סת"ם מעור בכור בהמה.

6.00 כיבוד קל

6.15 הרב יוסף אפרתי שליט"א
ראש המחלקה ההלכתית
מכון לחקר החקלאות עפ"י התורה
דרכי הקנין במכירת מבכירות.

7.00 הרה"ג ר' יצחק זילברשטין שליט"א
רב רמת אלחנן
ערלה ואיסורי הנאה.

בברכת ההצלחה
הנהלת בית המדרש

Flyer for a 1983 Jerusalem study day on the laws of bekhorot and orlah, with shiurim on the firstborn animal, gentile partnership, and selling firstborns.

הספרייה הלאומית, ארכיון מנחם פרידמן

יום לימוד בהלכות בכורות וערלה. · 27 Nisan 5743 (1983), per the flyer
https://www.nli.org.il/en/archives/NNL_ARCHIVE_AL997012947266705171

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 6

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

Genesis 4:23-5:24

The shnayim mikra practice — each verse twice in Hebrew, once in Targum Onkelos — carries us this morning from Lamech's chilling boast to his two wives, through the birth of Seth 'as another seed' after Abel, into the great genealogy of chapter 5: Adam to Enoch, the drumbeat of ויולד and וימת, years counted in the hundreds, until Enoch 'walked with God, and he was not.' It is the Torah's first attempt to count human time — and, as the commentators show, every verse in it is contested.

Genesis 4:23 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר לֶמֶךְ לְנָשָׁיו עָדָה וְצִלָּה שְׁמַעַן קוֹלִי נְשֵׁי לֶמֶךְ הַאְזֵנָּה אִמְרָתִי כִּי אִישׁ הָרַגְתִּי לְפִצְעִי וְיֶלֶד לְחַבֻּרָתִי׃

וַיֹּאמֶר לֶמֶךְ לְנָשָׁיו עָדָה וְצִלָּה שְׁמַעַן קוֹלִי נְשֵׁי לֶמֶךְ הַאְזֵנָּה אִמְרָתִי כִּי אִישׁ הָרַגְתִּי לְפִצְעִי וְיֶלֶד לְחַבֻּרָתִי׃

וַאֲמַר לֶמֶךְ לִנְשׁוֹהִי עָדָה וְצִלָּה שְׁמַעַן קָלִי נְשֵׁי לֶמֶךְ אֲצִיתָא לְמֵמְרִי לָא גַּבְרָא קְטָלִית דְּבְדִילֵהּ אֲנָא סָבִיל חוֹבִין וְאַף לָא עוֹלֵימָא חַבָּלִית דְּבְדִילֵהּ יִשְׁתֵּיצֵי זַרְעִי׃

Genesis 4:24 · ×2

כִּי שִׁבְעָתַיִם יֻקַּם־קָיִן וְלֶמֶךְ שִׁבְעִים וְשִׁבְעָה׃

כִּי שִׁבְעָתַיִם יֻקַּם־קָיִן וְלֶמֶךְ שִׁבְעִים וְשִׁבְעָה׃

אֲרֵי שַׁבְעָא דָּרִין אִיתְלְאוּ לְקַיִן הֲלָא לְלֶמֶךְ בְּרֵהּ שַׁבְעִין וְשַׁבְעָא׃

Genesis 4:25 · ×2

וַיֵּדַע אָדָם עוֹד אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתֵּלֶד בֵּן וַתִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁת כִּי שָׁת־לִי אֱלֹקִים זֶרַע אַחֵר תַּחַת הֶבֶל כִּי הֲרָגוֹ קָיִן׃

וַיֵּדַע אָדָם עוֹד אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתֵּלֶד בֵּן וַתִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁת כִּי שָׁת־לִי אֱלֹקִים זֶרַע אַחֵר תַּחַת הֶבֶל כִּי הֲרָגוֹ קָיִן׃

וְיָדַע אָדָם עוֹד יָת אִתְּתֵהּ וְיָלִידַת בַּר וּקְרַת יָת שְׁמֵהּ שֵׁת אֲרֵי אֲמָרַת יְהַב לִי יְיָ בַּר אוֹחֳרָן חֲלַף הֶבֶל דְּקַטְלֵהּ קָיִן׃

Genesis 4:26 · ×2

וּלְשֵׁת גַּם־הוּא יֻלַּד־בֵּן וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ אֱנוֹשׁ אָז הוּחַל לִקְרֹא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה׃

וּלְשֵׁת גַּם־הוּא יֻלַּד־בֵּן וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ אֱנוֹשׁ אָז הוּחַל לִקְרֹא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה׃

וּלְשֵׁת אַף הוּא אִתְיְלִיד בַּר וּקְרָא יָת שְׁמֵהּ אֱנוֹשׁ בְּכֵן בְּיוֹמוֹהִי חָלוּ בְנֵי אֱנָשָׁא מִלְצַלָּאָה בִּשְׁמָא דַּייָ׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

Genesis 5:1 · ×2

זֶה סֵּפֶר*(בספרי תימן סֵּפֶר בסמ״ך גדולה) תּוֹלְדֹת אָדָם בְּיוֹם בְּרֹא אֱלֹקִים אָדָם בִּדְמוּת אֱלֹקִים עָשָׂה אֹתוֹ׃

זֶה סֵּפֶר*(בספרי תימן סֵּפֶר בסמ״ך גדולה) תּוֹלְדֹת אָדָם בְּיוֹם בְּרֹא אֱלֹקִים אָדָם בִּדְמוּת אֱלֹקִים עָשָׂה אֹתוֹ׃

דֵּין סְפַר תּוּלְדַת אָדָם בְּיוֹמָא דִּבְרָא יְיָ אָדָם בִּדְמוּת אֱלֹקִים עֲבַד יָתֵהּ׃

Genesis 5:2 · ×2

זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בְּרָאָם וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָם אָדָם בְּיוֹם הִבָּרְאָם׃

זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בְּרָאָם וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָם אָדָם בְּיוֹם הִבָּרְאָם׃

דְּכַר וְנוּקְבָא בְּרָאנוּן וּבָרִיךְ יָתְהוֹן וּקְרָא יָת שְׁמָהוֹן אָדָם בְּיוֹמָא דְּאִתְבְּרִיאוּ׃

שנה ויולד שנין ואוליד

Genesis 5:3 · ×2

וַיְחִי אָדָם שְׁלֹשִׁים וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בִּדְמוּתוֹ כְּצַלְמוֹ וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁת׃

וַיְחִי אָדָם שְׁלֹשִׁים וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בִּדְמוּתוֹ כְּצַלְמוֹ וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁת׃

וַחֲיָא אָדָם מְאָה וּתְלָתִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בִּדְמוּתֵהּ דְּדָמֵי לֵהּ וּקְרָא יָת שְׁמֵהּ שֵׁת׃

Genesis 5:4 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ יְמֵי־אָדָם אֲחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־שֵׁת שְׁמֹנֶה מֵאֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃

וַיִּהְיוּ יְמֵי־אָדָם אֲחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־שֵׁת שְׁמֹנֶה מֵאֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃

וַהֲווֹ יוֹמֵי אָדָם בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת שֵׁת תַּמְנֵי מְאָה שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

מאות

Genesis 5:5 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי אָדָם אֲשֶׁר־חַי תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃

וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי אָדָם אֲשֶׁר־חַי תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃

וַהֲווֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי אָדָם דַּחֲיָא תְּשַׁע מְאָה וּתְלָתִין שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:6 · ×2

וַיְחִי־שֵׁת חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אֱנוֹשׁ׃

וַיְחִי־שֵׁת חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אֱנוֹשׁ׃

וַחֲיָא שֵׁת מְאָה וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת אֱנוֹשׁ׃

Genesis 5:7 · ×2

וַיְחִי־שֵׁת אָחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־אֱנוֹשׁ שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃

וַיְחִי־שֵׁת אָחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־אֱנוֹשׁ שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃

וַחֲיָא שֵׁת בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת אֱנוֹשׁ תַּמְנֵי מְאָה וּשְׁבַע שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

Genesis 5:8 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי־שֵׁת שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי־שֵׁת שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַהֲוּוֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי שֵׁת תִּשַׁע מְאָה וְתַרְתֵּי עַשְׂרֵי שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:9 · ×2

וַיְחִי אֱנוֹשׁ תִּשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־קֵינָן׃
וַיְחִי אֱנוֹשׁ תִּשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־קֵינָן׃
וַחֲיָא אֱנוֹשׁ תִּשְׁעִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת קֵינָן׃

Genesis 5:10 · ×2

וַיְחִי אֱנוֹשׁ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־קֵינָן חֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי אֱנוֹשׁ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־קֵינָן חֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא אֱנוֹשׁ בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת קֵינָן תַּמְנֵי מְאָה וַחֲמֵשׁ עַשְׂרֵי שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 5:11 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי אֱנוֹשׁ חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי אֱנוֹשׁ חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַהֲוּוֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי אֱנוֹשׁ תְּשַׁע מְאָה וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:12 · ×2

וַיְחִי קֵינָן שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־מָהֲלַלְאֵל׃
וַיְחִי קֵינָן שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־מָהֲלַלְאֵל׃
וַחֲיָא קֵינָן שַׁבְעִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת מַהֲלַלְאֵל׃

Genesis 5:13 · ×2

וַיְחִי קֵינָן אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־מָהֲלַלְאֵל אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַיְחִי קֵינָן אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־מָהֲלַלְאֵל אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא קֵינָן בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת מַהֲלַלְאֵל תַּמְנֵי מְאָה וְאַרְבְּעִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 5:14 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי קֵינָן עֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי קֵינָן עֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת׃
וַהֲוּוֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי קֵינָן תְּשַׁע מְאָה וַעֲשַׂר שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:15 · ×2

וַיְחִי מָהֲלַלְאֵל חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־יָרֶד׃
וַיְחִי מָהֲלַלְאֵל חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־יָרֶד׃
וַחֲיָא מַהֲלַלְאֵל שִׁתִּין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת יָרֶד׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

Genesis 5:16 · ×2

וַיְחִי מָהֲלַלְאֵל אָחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־יֶ֔רֶד שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים שָׁנָ֖ה וּשְׁמֹנֶ֣ה מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיְחִי מָהֲלַלְאֵל אָחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־יֶ֔רֶד שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים שָׁנָ֖ה וּשְׁמֹנֶ֣ה מֵא֑וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא מַהֲלַלְאֵל בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת יֶרֶד תַּמְנֵי מְאָה וּתְלָתִין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 5:17 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ֙ כָּל־יְמֵ֣י מָהֲלַלְאֵ֔ל חָמֵ֥שׁ וְתִשְׁעִ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁמֹנֶ֣ה מֵא֔וֹת שָׁנָ֖ה וַיָּמֹֽת׃
וַיִּהְיוּ֙ כָּל־יְמֵ֣י מָהֲלַלְאֵ֔ל חָמֵ֥שׁ וְתִשְׁעִ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁמֹנֶ֣ה מֵא֔וֹת שָׁנָ֖ה וַיָּמֹֽת׃
וַהֲווֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי מָהֲלַלְאֵל תַּמְנֵי מְאָה וְתִשְׁעִין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:18 · ×2

וַיְחִי־יֶ֔רֶד שְׁתַּ֥יִם וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּמְאַ֥ת שָׁנָ֖ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד אֶת־חֲנֹֽךְ׃
וַיְחִי־יֶ֔רֶד שְׁתַּ֥יִם וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּמְאַ֥ת שָׁנָ֖ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד אֶת־חֲנֹֽךְ׃
וַחֲיָא יֶרֶד מְאָה וּשְׁתִּין וְתַרְתֵּין שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת חֲנוֹךְ׃

Genesis 5:19 · ×2

וַיְחִי־יֶ֔רֶד אָחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־חֲנֹ֔וךְ שְׁמֹנֶ֣ה מֵא֔וֹת שָׁנָ֖ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיְחִי־יֶ֔רֶד אָחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־חֲנֹ֔וךְ שְׁמֹנֶ֣ה מֵא֔וֹת שָׁנָ֖ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַחֲיָא יֶרֶד בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת חֲנוֹךְ תַּמְנֵי מְאָה שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 5:20 · ×2

וַיִּהְיוּ֙ כָּל־יְמֵי־יֶ֔רֶד שְׁתַּ֥יִם וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּתְשַׁ֥ע מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיָּמֹֽת׃
וַיִּהְיוּ֙ כָּל־יְמֵי־יֶ֔רֶד שְׁתַּ֥יִם וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּתְשַׁ֥ע מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֔ה וַיָּמֹֽת׃
וַהֲווֹ כָּל יוֹמֵי יֶרֶד תְּשַׁע מְאָה וּשְׁתִּין וְתַרְתֵּין שְׁנִין וּמִית׃

Genesis 5:21 · ×2

וַיְחִ֣י חֲנ֔וֹךְ חָמֵ֥שׁ וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד אֶת־מְתוּשָֽׁלַח׃
וַיְחִ֣י חֲנ֔וֹךְ חָמֵ֥שׁ וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד אֶת־מְתוּשָֽׁלַח׃
וַחֲיָא חֲנוֹךְ שִׁתִּין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד יָת מְתוּשֶׁלַח׃

Genesis 5:22 · ×2

וַיִּתְהַלֶּךְ־חֲנ֣וֹךְ אֶת־הָאֱלֹקִ֗ים אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֙ אֶת־מְתוּשֶׁ֔לַח שְׁלֹ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וַיִּתְהַלֶּךְ־חֲנ֣וֹךְ אֶת־הָאֱלֹקִ֗ים אַחֲרֵי֙ הוֹלִידוֹ֙ אֶת־מְתוּשֶׁ֔לַח שְׁלֹ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֑ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנֽוֹת׃
וְהַלִיךְ חֲנוֹךְ בְּדַחֲלְתָּא דַיְיָ בָּתַר דְּאוֹלִיד יָת מְתוּשֶׁלַח תְּלַת מְאָה שְׁנִין וְאוֹלִיד בְּנִין וּבְנָן׃

Genesis 5:23 · ×2

וַיְהִ֣י כָל־יְמֵי֮ חֲנוֹךְ֒ חָמֵ֥שׁ וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁלֹ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָֽה׃
וַיְהִ֣י כָל־יְמֵי֮ חֲנוֹךְ֒ חָמֵ֥שׁ וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁלֹ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָֽה׃
וַהֲוָה כָּל יוֹמֵי חֲנוֹךְ תְּלַת מְאָה וּשְׁתִּין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

Genesis 5:24 · ×2

וַיִּתְהַלֶּךְ חֲנוֹךְ אֶת־הָאֱלֹקִים וְאֵינֶנּוּ כִּי־לָקַח אֹתוֹ אֱלֹקִים׃
וַיִּתְהַלֶּךְ חֲנוֹךְ אֶת־הָאֱלֹקִים וְאֵינֶנּוּ כִּי־לָקַח אֹתוֹ אֱלֹקִים׃
וְהַלִּיךְ חֲנוֹךְ בְּדַחַלְתָּא דַּיְיָ וְלֵיתוֹהִי אֲרֵי (לָא) אֲמִית יָתֵהּ יְיָ׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 4:23

Lamech's speech is poetry (מליצת השיר), and כי is interrogative — he never killed anyone. He's rebuking wives who 'embittered his life,' arguing a fortiori: if God bore Cain's guilt and said 'sevenfold,' how much more will He avenge innocent me. Shadal even cites Herder on the verse.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 4:23

'ויאמר למך' is chronologically displaced (מאוחר בפרשה), and הרגתי is past-for-future like 'השדה נתתי כסף' — 'I WILL kill.' The wives' real fear: bearing children who, as seventh from Cain, would be killed — so Lamech reassures them that HE is the seventh.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 4:23

The speech is 'עבר מוקדם' — spoken BEFORE the children were born. Lamech's guilt is not murder but a contraceptive sin: he gave his wife 'a cup of sterilizing herbs' to keep her barren, 'to spill his seed in vain' — 'איש הרגתי' means he killed his own seed.

Netinah LaGer · Gen 4:23

A defense of Onkelos's denial-reading against emenders: פצע and חבורה are sin-terms (Isaiah's 'stained with sins'), so 'לא גברא קטלית דבדילה אנא סביל חובין' needs no textual surgery — the Aramaic is commentary, not corruption.

Em LaMikra · Gen 5:24

The 'Enoch didn't die' reading is late. Bereshit Rabbah puts Enoch in 'the register of the wicked' — 'Enoch was a hypocrite, sometimes righteous, sometimes wicked,' and God 'took him while still righteous.' The rapture tradition is an inversion of an earlier, darker Enoch.

Cassuto · Gen 5:24

Since v.23 already closed Enoch's 365 years, 'ויתהלך חנוך את האלקים' in v.24 is wordplay with a new sense: the whole verse stands in for the missing וימת of the other paragraphs. The 'walking' here IS the death — a euphemism, not a biography.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 5:24

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

'כי לקח אתו אלקים' means simply: he died — as in 'קח נא את נפשי' (Jonah 4:3) and 'את מחמד עיניך הנני לקח ממך' (Ezekiel 24:16). The absence of וימת is honorific, glossed by Psalm 73:24, 'תקחני ואחר כבוד.' The discerning reader will understand.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 4:23

לא גברא קטלית דבדילה אנא סביל חובין כי איש הרגתי לפצעי

Onkelos turns Lamech's boast into a denial: 'I did NOT kill a man for which I bear guilt' — reading כי as interrogative (did I kill?). The murder-song becomes a self-defense speech, and the wives are being rebuked for provoking an innocent man.

Gen 4:24

ארי שבעא דרין אתלאו לקין כי שבעתים יקם‍קין

'Seven generations were SUSPENDED for Cain' — not sevenfold vengeance but seven generations of reprieve. Onkelos reads the midrashic timeline into the verse: divine patience measured in generations, not multiples.

Gen 4:26

בכן ביומוהי חלו בני אנשא מלצלאה בשמא דיי ׳אז הוחל לקרא בשם ה

Onkelos reads הוחל as 'desisted' (from חול, to cease) rather than 'was profaned': 'then in his days the children of men desisted from praying in the name of God' — inserting prayer (לצלאה) and a time-stamp (ביומוהי) into a famously ambiguous verse.

Gen 5:1

בדמות אלקים עבד יתה בדמות אלקים עשה אתו

Where the divine name is אלקים and not the Tetragrammaton, Onkelos leaves 'in the likeness of God' untouched — no paraphrase, no softening. His anti-anthropomorphism is selective: the reverent distance is reserved for the Name itself.

Gen 5:3

ואוליד בדמותה דדמי לה ויולד בדמותו כצלמו

'He begot in his likeness, which is like HIM' — the Aramaic דדמי לה pins the resemblance to Adam, not to God, disambiguating whose likeness Seth carries. A translator's quiet theology: the image is transmitted father to son.

Gen 5:22, 24

והליך חנוך בדחלתא דיי ויתהלך חנוך אתהאלקים

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

The classic Onkelos move: 'walking WITH God' becomes 'walking in the FEAR of God' (בדחלתא). And in 5:24 he demystifies the rapture entirely — כילקח אתו אלקים becomes יתה יי ארי אמית, 'for God caused him to die.' No ascent; a death.

Gen 5:3-5

מאה ותלתין שנין שלשים ומאת שנה

Onkelos regularizes the number order: Hebrew's 'thirty and a hundred years' becomes Aramaic 'a hundred and thirty years' (שנין for שנה throughout). The genealogy's arithmetic is re-set in the target language's hundreds-first convention — translation as bookkeeping.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

All twelve of Rashi's comments on Genesis 4:23-5:24, printed in full — from the blind Lamech of the midrash to Enoch's early death, with his two rival readings of Lamech's song sitting side by side.

שמען קולי.
שֶׁהָיוּ פּוֹרְשׁוֹת מִמֶּנּוּ מִתַּשְׁמִישׁ,

שמען קולי *HEAR MY VOICE — For his wives separated from him because he had killed Cain and Tubal-Cain, his own son.*

לְפִי שֶׁהָרַג אֶת קַיִן וְאֶת תּוּבַל קַיִן בְּנוֹ,

Lamech was blind and Tubal-Cain used to lead him.

שֶׁהָיָה לֶמֶךְ סוּמָא וְתוּבַל קַיִן מוֹשְׁכוֹ,

The latter saw Cain and thought him to be an animal.

וְרָאָה אֶת קַיִן וְנִדְמָה לוֹ כְּחַיָּה וְאָמַר לְאָבִיו לִמְשֹׁךְ בַּקֶּשֶׁת וַהֲרָגוֹ,

He therefore told his father to draw the bow, and thus Lamech killed him.

וְכֵיוָן שֶׁיָּדַע שֶׁהוּא קַיִן זְקֵנוֹ הִכָּה כַּף אֶל כַּף וְסָפַק אֶת בְּנוֹ בֵּינֵיהֶם וַהֲרָגוֹ,

As soon as he learned that it was his forefather Cain, he smote his hands together, struck his son between them and so killed him too.

וְהָיוּ נָשָׁיו פּוֹרְשׁוֹת מִמֶּנּוּ וְהוּא מְפַיְּסָן:

His wives thereupon separated from him, and he endeavoured to appease them,

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

שמען קולי.

לְהִשָּׁמַע לִי לְתַשְׁמִישׁ, וְכִי אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר הָרַגְתִּי לְפִצְעִי הוּא נֶהֱרָג,

saying שמען קולי *"Hear my voice"— obey me and return to me:*

for the man I slew — was he slain by my wounding?

i. e. did I wound him with premeditation, that the wound should be called by my name (i. e. attributed to me);

וְכִי אֲנִי פְּצַעְתִּיו מֵזִיד שֶׁיְּהֵא הַפֶּצַע קָרוּי עַל שְׁמִי? וְיֶלֶד אֲשֶׁר הָרַגְתִּי, לְחַבָּרְתִּי נֶהֱרָג? כְּלוֹמַר, עַל יְדֵי חַבָּרְתִּי? בִּתְמִיהָה, וַהֲלֹא שׁוֹגֵג אָנִי וְלֹא מֵזִיד, לֹא זֶהוּ פִּצְעִי וְלֹא זֶהוּ חַבָּרְתִּי:

and the child that I slew — was it slain by my blow?

(i. e. by a blow directed intentionally by me?) [Rashi here inserts the word בתמיה *which he uses frequently to direct that the preceding words should be read as a question.] Did I not act inadvertently and not with premeditation?*

This was not my wound, nor was this my blow!

פצע.

מַכַּת חֶרֶב אוֹ חֵץ מקא"דורה בְּלַעַז:

פצע *wound, is the stroke inflicted by a sword or arrow (old French macheure).*

כי שבעתים יקם קין.

קַיִן שֶׁהָרַג מֵזִיד נִתְלָה לוֹ עַד שִׁבְעָה דוֹרוֹת,

כי שבעתים יקם קין *IF CAIN SHALL BE AVENGED SEVENFOLD — (according to Rashi, as previously explained, it signifies "If vengeance shall be taken on Cain after seven generations").*

אֲנִי שֶׁהָרַגְתִּי שׁוֹגֵג לֹא כָּל שֶׁכֵּן שֶׁיִּתָּלֶה לִי שִׁבְעִיּוֹת הַרְבֵּה:

If in the case of Cain who killed with premeditation the punishment was suspended for him until the seventh generation, in the case of myself who slew inadvertently does it not necessarily follow that it should be suspended for me until many seven generations?

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

שבעים ושבעה.

לְשׁוֹן רִבּוּי שְׁבִיעִיּוֹת אָחַז לוֹ, כָּךְ דָּרַשׁ רַבִּי תַּנְחוּמָא.

שבעים ושבעה *SEVENTY AND SEVEN — He uses a term that denotes many periods of seven generations.*

וּמִדְרַשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה לֹא הָרַג לֶמֶךְ כְּלוּם,

Thus did R. Tanchuma 1:1:11 explain this passage;

וְנָשָׁיו פּוֹרְשׁוֹת מִמֶּנּוּ מִשֶּׁקִּימוּ פְּרִיָה וּרְבִיָה,

but the Midrash Rabbah (Genesis Rabbah 23:4) does not mention that Lamech slew anyone at all, and only states that his wives had lived apart from him after they had born children, because God's decree had been issued that Cain's descendants should be exterminated after seven generations.

לְפִי שֶׁנִּגְזְרָה גְּזֵרָה לְכַלּוֹת זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל קַיִן לְאַחַר שִׁבְעָה דוֹרוֹת, אָמְרוּ מָה אָנוּ יוֹלְדוֹת לַבֶּהָלָה?

They said, "Why should we bear children only to be destroyed?

לְמָחָר הַמַּבּוּל בָּא וְשׁוֹטֵף אֶת הַכֹּל וְהוּא אוֹמֵר לָהֶן וְכִי אִישׁ הָרַגְתִּי לְפִצְעִי? וְכִי אֲנִי הָרַגְתִּי אֶת הֶבֶל,

Soon the Flood will come and will sweep everyone away!" Lamech then said unto them, "Did 'I' slay a man לפצעי *for my wounding" (i.e.*

שֶׁהָיָה אִישׁ בְּקוֹמָה וְיֶלֶד בַּשָּׁנִים, שֶׁיְּהֵא זַרְעִי כָּלֶה בְּאוֹתוֹ עָוֹן?

that I should be wounded — punished)?

וּמַה קַיִן שֶׁהָרַג נְתָלָה לוֹ שִׁבְעָה דוֹרוֹת, אֲנִי שֶׁלֹּא הָרַגְתִּי,

Did "I" slay Abel who was a man in height but a child in years, that my descendants should be exterminated on account of this sin (the sin of Cain who killed Abel)?

לֹא כָּ"שׁ שֶׁיִּתָּלוּ לִי שְׁבִיעִיּוֹת הַרְבֵּה? וְזֶהוּ קַל וָחֹמֶר שֶׁל שְׁטוּת,

If Cain who did kill had his punishment suspended until the seventh generation, I who have not killed — does it not necessarily follow that my punishment) should be suspended for many seven generations?

אִם כֵּן אֵין הַקָּבָ"ה גּוֹבֶה אֶת חוֹבוֹ וּמְקַיֵּם אֶת דְּבָרוֹ:

This, however, is an absurd argument a fortiori, for if so, the Holy One, blessed be He, could never exact his debt nor fulfil his word.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

וידע אדם וגו׳.

בָּא לוֹ לֶמֶךְ אֵצֶל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן וְקָבַל עַל נָשָׁיו, אָמַר לָהֶם:

וידע אדם *AND ADAM KNEW — Lamech came to Adam Harishon, complaining about his wives.*

וְכִי עֲלֵיכֶם לְדַקְדֵּק עַל גְּזֵרָתוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם?

He (Adam) said to them: "Is it for you to be overparticular regarding God's decrees?

אַתֶּם עֲשׂוּ מִצְוָתְכֶם וְהוּא יַעֲשֶׂה אֶת שֶׁלּוֹ. אָמְרוּ לוֹ: קְשֹׁט עַצְמְךָ תְּחִלָּה,

You do your duty, and He will do His!" They replied to him: "First correct yourself:

וַהֲלֹא פָּרַשְׁתָּ מֵאִשְׁתְּךָ זֶה מֵאָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה מִשֶּׁנִּקְנְסָה מִיתָה עַל יְדֶךָ: מִיָּד וַיֵּדַע אָדָם וְגוֹמֵר. וּמַהוּ עוֹד,

have you not lived apart from your wife these 130 years, ever since, through you, death was decreed as a punishment?" At once וידע אדם עוד וגו׳ *"Adam knew his wife* עוד *" — What signifies the word* עוד*?*

לְלַמֵּד שֶׁנִּתּוֹסְפָה לוֹ תַּאֲוָה עַל תַּאֲוָתוֹ (בראשית רבה):

It is used here to teach that his love for her was now greater than before (Genesis Rabbah 23:4-5).

אז הוחל.

לְשׁוֹן חֻלִּין, לִקְרֹא אֶת שְׁמוֹת הָאָדָם וְאֶת שְׁמוֹת הָעֲצַבִּים בִּשְׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה לַעֲשׂוֹתָן עָ"ז וְלִקְרוֹתָן אֱלֹהוּת:

אז הוחל *THEN IT WAS BEGUN [TO CALL etc.] — The word* הוחל *must be connected in meaning with* חולין *"profane matters ") viz, calling the names of men and the names of idols after the name of the Holy One, blessed be He — making them the objects of idolatrous worship and calling them Deities (Genesis Rabbah 23:7).*

זה ספר תולדות אדם.

זוֹ הִיא סְפִירַת תּוֹלְדוֹת אָדָם, וּמִדְרְשֵׁי אַגָּדָה יֵשׁ רַבִּים:

זה ספר תולדות אדם *THIS IS THE BOOK OF THE GENERATIONS OF ADAM — This is the record (or, enumeration) of the generations of Adam.*

There are however, many Midrashic observations on this verse

ביום ברא וגו׳.

מַגִּיד שֶׁבַּיּוֹם שֶׁנִּבְרָא הוֹלִיד:

ביום ברא וגו׳ *IN THE DAY THAT [GOD] CREATED etc. — This states that on the day when he was created he begot progeny (Genesis Rabbah 24:7).*

שלשים ומאת שנה.

עַד כָּאן פָּרַשׁ מִן הָאִשָּׁה (בראשית רבה):

שלשים ומאת שנה *A HUNDRED AND THIRTY YEARS — Until then he lived apart from his wife (Genesis Rabbah 24:6).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

ויתהלך חנוך.

צַדִּיק הָיָה וְקַל בְּדַעְתּוֹ לָשׁוּב לְהַרְשִׁיעַ,

ויתהלך חנוך *AND ENOCH WALKED [WITH GOD] — He was a righteous man, but his mind was easily induced) to turn from his righteous ways and to become wicked.*

לְפִיכָךְ מְהֵר הַקָּבָ"ה וְסִלְּקוֹ וֶהֱמִיתוֹ קֹדֶם זְמַנּוֹ,

The Holy One, blessed be He, therefore took him away quickly and made him die before his full time.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁשִּׁנָּה הַכָּתוּב בְּמִיתָתוֹ לִכְתֹּב וְאֵינֶנּוּ בָּעוֹלָם לְמַלְּאוֹת שְׁנוֹתָיו (בראשית רבה):

This is why Scripture uses a different expression when referring to his death by writing ואיננו *"and he was not", meaning, he was not in the world to complete the number of his years.*

כי לקח אותו.

לִפְנֵי זְמַנּוֹ, כְּמוֹ הִנְנִי לֹקֵחַ מִמְּךָ אֶת מַחְמַד עֵינֶיךָ (יחזקאל כ"ד):

כי לקח אותו *FOR GOD TOOK HIM — before his time;*

a similar meaning of לקח *"to take" we find in (Ezekiel 24:16), "I take away from thee the desire of thine eyes [by a plague]".*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three comments, three relationships to the midrash

On שמען קולי (4:23) Rashi gives the Tanchuma's blind-Lamech story as a tight paraphrase: 'ונדמה לו כחיה ואמר לאביו למשוך בקשת והרגו ...שהיה למך סומא ותובל קין מושכו' — the midrash's long narrative compressed to exactly the details the verse needs, closing with Rashi's own bridge back to the verse: 'והיו נשיו פורשות ממנו והוא מפייסן.' The aggadah is quarried, not quoted. Then, in the very next comment, Rashi pivots to pure peshat: 'מזיד שיהא הפצע קרוי על שמי וכי אני פצעתיו?' — the interrogative כי, the rhetorical questions, 'והלא שוגג אני ולא מזיד.' Two rival Lamechs in adjacent comments, midrash then grammar, with no apology for the contradiction.

On שלשים ומאת שנה (5:3) Rashi does something bolder: unattributed compression that strips the aggadah out. Bereshit Rabbah 24:6's 130-year digression is wild — spirits coupling with the separated Adam and Eve, 'מאה ושלשים שנה שפרשה חוה מאדם היו רוחות הזכרים מתחממים ממנה כל.' Rashi flattens all of it into five dry words: 'עד כאן פרש מן האשה.' The timeline survives; the demons don't. And on וידע אדם עוד (4:25) he imports the midrash's courtroom dialogue nearly verbatim — the wives turning Adam's own rebuke back on him: 'שנה, קשט עצמך תחלה והלא פרשת מאשתך זה מאה ושלשים' — then glosses עוד with the midrash's own line, 'על תאותו נתוספה לו תאוה.' Quarry, pivot, import: three comments, three different contracts with the sources.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

Friday, 9 October 2026 · Aliyah 6/7 (Genesis 4:23-5:24) · Daf Bekhorot 21

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the genealogy

Three words that carry the aliyah's drumbeat — the years, the begetting, the hundreds. Maagarim's live sweep was blocked this morning (Cloudflare), so these narratives run on Klein, Jastrow, and BDB via Sefaria; the Historical Dictionary's citation arcs will have to wait. (A standing note: CAL, the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon, prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria.)

שָׁנָה

Klein · שנה

f.n.

— (dual שנתים, pl. שנים) year.

Jastrow · שינה

f.

— sleep. Ber. 3ᵇ מעולם לא עבר ... בש׳ midnight never found me asleep. Ib. 62ᵇ בעמוד וכ׳ ש׳ sleep at morning dawn (v. שינא I). Meg. 15ᵇ שנת וכ׳, v. נדד. Succ. 26ᵃ שינת, v. עראי. Ib. במוסר שינתו וכ׳ when he g

Jastrow · שנה

שנה appears thirty times in this aliyah — the genealogy's metronome: שלשים ומאת שנה ויולד ... וימת. ויהיו כל ימי אדם ... ויחי אדם. Klein gives the bare gloss: year (dual שנתים, plural שנים). Jastrow's entry opens the wider room: the year as a moral and calendrical unit — ראש השנה, עלתה לו שנה, and Berakhot 55a's 'three things must be prayed for: a good king, a good year, and a good dream,' where the year itself becomes an object of prayer. The arc: from a lifespan-counter in Adam's ledger to a sanctified unit you pray for. (Disambiguated from the שינה 'sleep' homograph that shares Jastrow's page.)

יוֹלֶד

Jastrow · יולד

Jastrow · יולד

m. pl.

— יולדים (b. h.; parents. Keth. VII, 6 המקללת יולדיו בפניו she who curses his (her husband's) parents in his presence; quot. ib. 72ᵇ יולידיו (an emphatic form), and interpreted במקללת יולידיו בפני מולידיו (v

BDB · ילד

— vb. bear, bring forth, beget (NH id.; Aramaic יליד, יליד, ; Arabic bear, bring forth, so Ethiopic Assyrian alâdu, COTGloss)—

ויולד is the aliyah's other drumbeat — fourteen occurrences, every generation pivoting on it. BDB traces ילד across the Semitic map: Aramaic יליד, Arabic ולד, Ethiopic walad, Assyrian alâdu — a pan-Semitic birth-word. Jastrow adds the rabbinic afterlife: יולד as 'parents' (Kethubot: cursing one's יולדיו). The arc: a root so old it is shared from Ashur to Arabia, and in this chapter it becomes the engine of human continuity set against the counter-refrain

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

stborns, firstlings, and the first genealogy — the daf reads an animal's body for evidence, the aliyah counts Adam's ye

וימת — begetting against dying, the two verbs alternating down the generations like breathing.

מֵאָה

Klein · מאה

f.n.

Jastrow · מאה

— (b. h.) one hundred. Tosef. Ber. VII (VI), 24 מ׳ מצות one hundred religious acts. Ib. 8; a. v. fr.—Pesik. Vattom., p. 131ᵇ מ׳ חסר שתים ninety-eight; a. fr.—Du. מאתים. Ex. R. s. 23; Mekh. B’shall., s. 6. Macc. I, 2. Ke

BDB · מאה

— n.f. hundred (NH id.; MI 20 מאתן (du.); SI5 מאת, מאתים (du.); Ph. מאת, מאתם (du.); Assyrian mê (prob., Dl§ 75), TelAm. me-at WklTelAm. 20; Arabic ; Sab. מאת, מאתם OsZMG x. 1856, 49; CIS iv. i. 6, 4; 46, 6; מאה Eu

מאות — the hundreds that make the lifespans vast: שלשים ומאת שנה, שמנה מאות שנה, מאות שנה תשע. BDB's entry is a museum of the ancient Near East: Moabite מאתן, Phoenician מאת, Assyrian mê, Tel Amarna me-at, Arabic , Sabaean מאתם. The number-word traveled the whole Semitic world before Genesis used it to count Adam's years. And it lands, oddly, in stone: BDB's second entry, מגדל המאה — the Tower of the Hundred on Jerusalem's northern wall (Nehemiah 3:1). From counting years to naming towers: the hundred as a unit of awe, whether of time or of masonry.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr